

Odisha Quiz

QM: Prayag Mohanty



Rules

- This is a quiz on some **offbeat topics in Odisha**. Some obvious, some hyper-niche but mostly gettable.
- Not your usual, straightforward peters like Konark, Puri, Odissi etc. Slightly more in-depth yet interesting.
- Hopefully you get to learn & have fun!
- Let me know what you think about this quiz: **topper1728@gmail.com**
- Reach out, if you want interesting quizzes like this one.

1.

- **X** Island is located 42 km off the coast of Abu Dhabi, UAE. It is known as a center for pearl trading, with evidence of human settlement dating back over 7,000 years.
- **X** Garden Mall is a enclosed shopping mall in Yerevan. It was the first mall to open in Armenia.
- **X** is a traditonal Odia curry made with a mix of lentils (like toor dal) and a variety of vegetables, often including raw banana, brinjal, green papaya, and pumpkins. The dish is typically prepared with a special spice blend known as **Y**
- **Y** is a whole spice blend consisting of *methi, kalonji, jeera, rai, and saunf*.
- **ID X & Y [5+5]**

safety slide

Dalma



Pancha Phutana

It refers to "five spices"



2.

- Orissa was renamed to Odisha in 2011, the last state to be renamed until another state in 2026. Both changes were intended to correct historical inaccuracies and reclaim their state's linguistic identity.
- Since 2011, all government institutions have updated their names except for one. This constitutional body still carries *Orissa* in its name today, bound by the Government of India Act, 1935, which has never been amended.
- Some claim it symbolizes its location as a historic stronghold.
- **Which Indian state was renamed? [5]**
- **Which institution still bears the name Orissa? [5]**

safety slide

Keralam

Kerala to “Keralam” Gets Union Cabinet Nod

February 24, 2026 | Historic Name Change Move



Cultural Significance

- “Keralam” reflects original Malayalam identity
- Rooted in linguistic heritage

Background

- Resolution Passed by Kerala Assembly (June 2024)

Constitutional Process

- Under **Article 3** of the Constitution
- Bill ➡ President ➡ State Assembly ➡ Parliament

Aligning State Identity with Language & Culture



Orissa High Court

As is the case with Bombay, Madras, Calcutta HC



3.

- *Pattachitra* is one of Odisha's oldest surviving art forms, deeply rooted in the Jagannath cult and temple traditions. It is traditionally crafted on cloth or dried palm leaves, using colours derived entirely from natural sources.
- Each colour has a distinct origin — black from lamp soot, blue from the indigo plant etc. But one colour stands apart.
- The white used in Pattachitra comes from a single marine product, also used heavily in religious rituals
- **What is the source of this white colour? [10]**

safety slide

Powdered conch shells



4.

- Located in Cuttack, B K Industrial Training Center is the only institute in India, that offers a specialized vocational course in the art of _____ making.
- Born in Salepur in 1902, the namesake was named after years of *desperate* prayers.
- While he went on to build an iconic brand, it was his son's innovation to this product - a more denser texture - that increased _____'s shelf life & widespread appeal.
- **FITB [5]**
- **Who is B K [5]**

safety slide

Rasagolla



Bikalananda Kar

Bikalananda Kar's

RASAGOLA

WE SWEETEN YOUR LIFE...



5.

- Odisha FC had immediately grown its popularity post its inception which resulted in the formation of its supporters group
- Described as an unstoppable force, the name of the group also alludes to the deity associated with the region.
- **What's the name of the group? [10]**

safety slide

Juggernauts



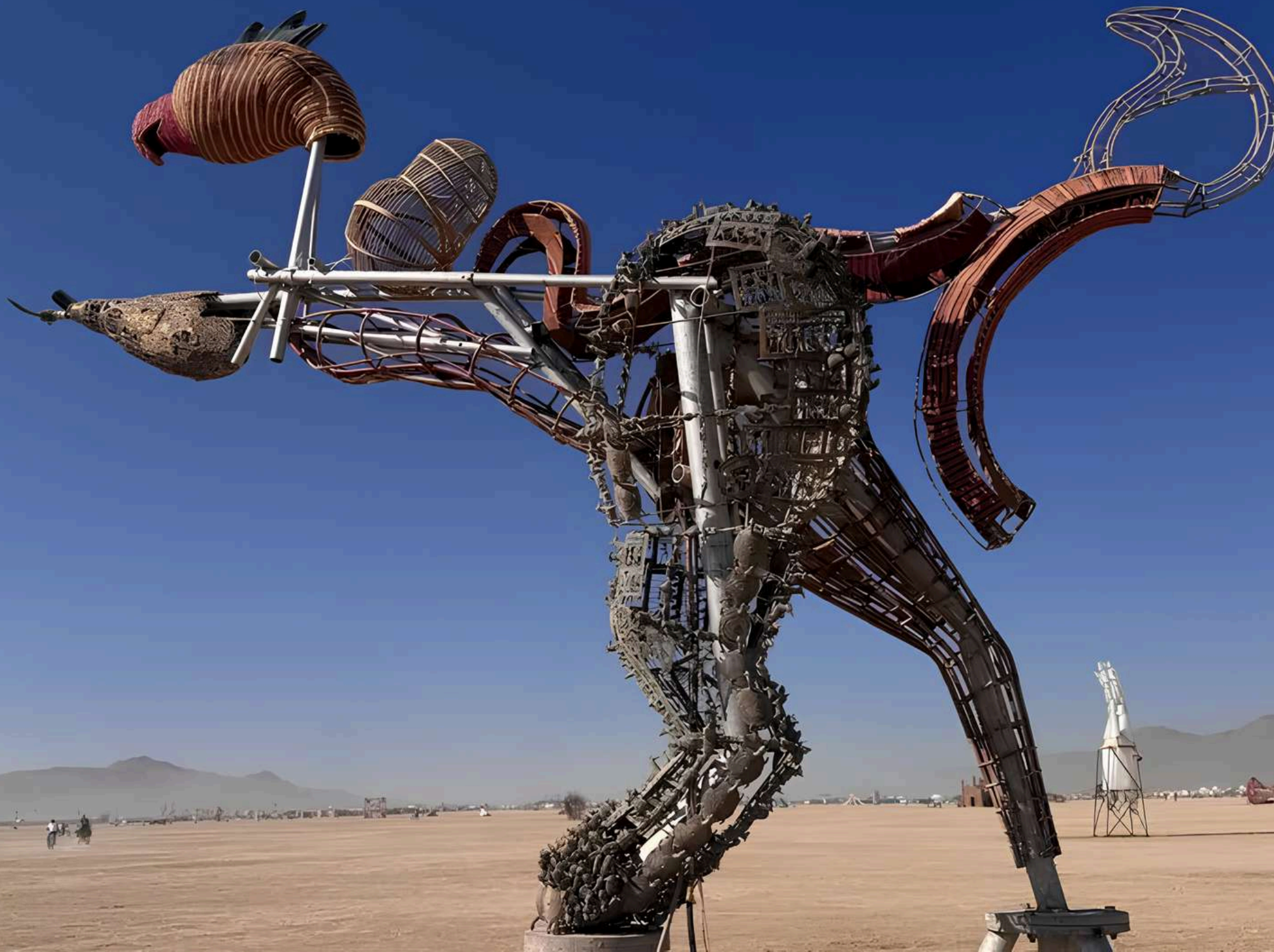
6.

- Boito is a fashion brand founded by Richa Maheshwari in 2022, known for blending traditional handwoven textiles from Odisha with modern designs.
- Its name & logo are inspired by an annual festival. **Which festival? [4]**
- At Burning Man 2025, Boito built an 18-foot metal sculpture that represented a chimeric creature from a 15th-century Odia retelling of the Mahabharata — one that carries parts of nine different animals and beings. **Which creature? [6]**

(Images follow)



Boito



safety slide

Bali Jatra



Navagunjara



7.

- Aruna Khumbha is a 10 m-tall monolithic black stone pillar with an idol of Aruna at the top. It is about 6 m away from the Singhdwara of the Jagannath Temple in Puri.
- According to Madala Panji, the Aruna Khumbha was transplanted from another location to its current location by a Maratha guru, Brahmachari Gosain, in the 18th century. It was apt, since the main deity of the original location was considered identical with Vishnu.
- The painting (next slide), one of the rare instances, depicts the interiors of the structure at this location in 1912, which has been closed to the public since.
- **Which location/structure? [10]**







safety slide

Konark Sun Temple



8.

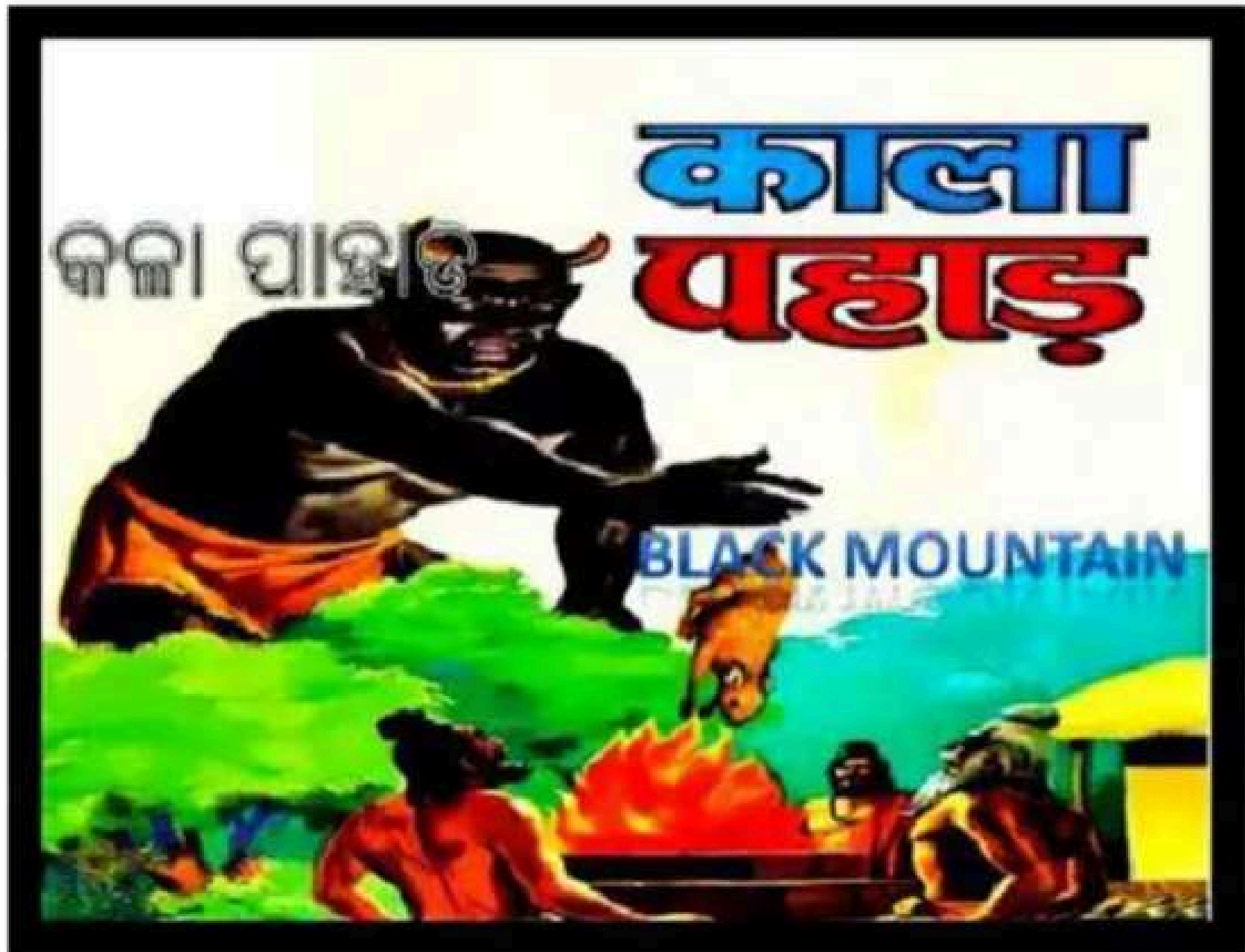
- This Muslim iconoclast camped with his army on the banks of the Mahanadi, beyond the main temple of a certain goddess, intending to destroy it.
- Before he could begin, a beautiful milk-maid dressed in gold jewellery arrived at the camp with a basket of milk, curd and butter. The goddess had come in the guise of a milk woman, sold butter to the general and his soldiers — who after consuming it, died.
- His tomb and those of his soldiers still stand on the outskirts of Sambalpur.
- **Who is this goddess**, who gives her name to the city of Sambalpur? [5]
- **Name this general**, whose name is associated with a dark history in Odisha? [5]

safety slide

Maa Samaleshwari



Kalapahad



9.

- In 1921, Lord Sinha appointed him as the first Health Minister for the newly formed province of Bihar and Orissa.
- At 73 years, he famously refused to sanction ₹75,000 for a minister's house. He lived in a rented house & established India's first Radium Institute at Ranchi.
- Before getting his title, his colleagues nicknamed him "Cato", after the Roman senator, for his sharp wit and moral conscience in the legislature.
- These were just a few things, we take *pride* knowing him for a whole different reason. **Who/what title? [10]**

safety slide

"Kulabruddha" / "Utkala Gauraba"; Madhusudhan Das

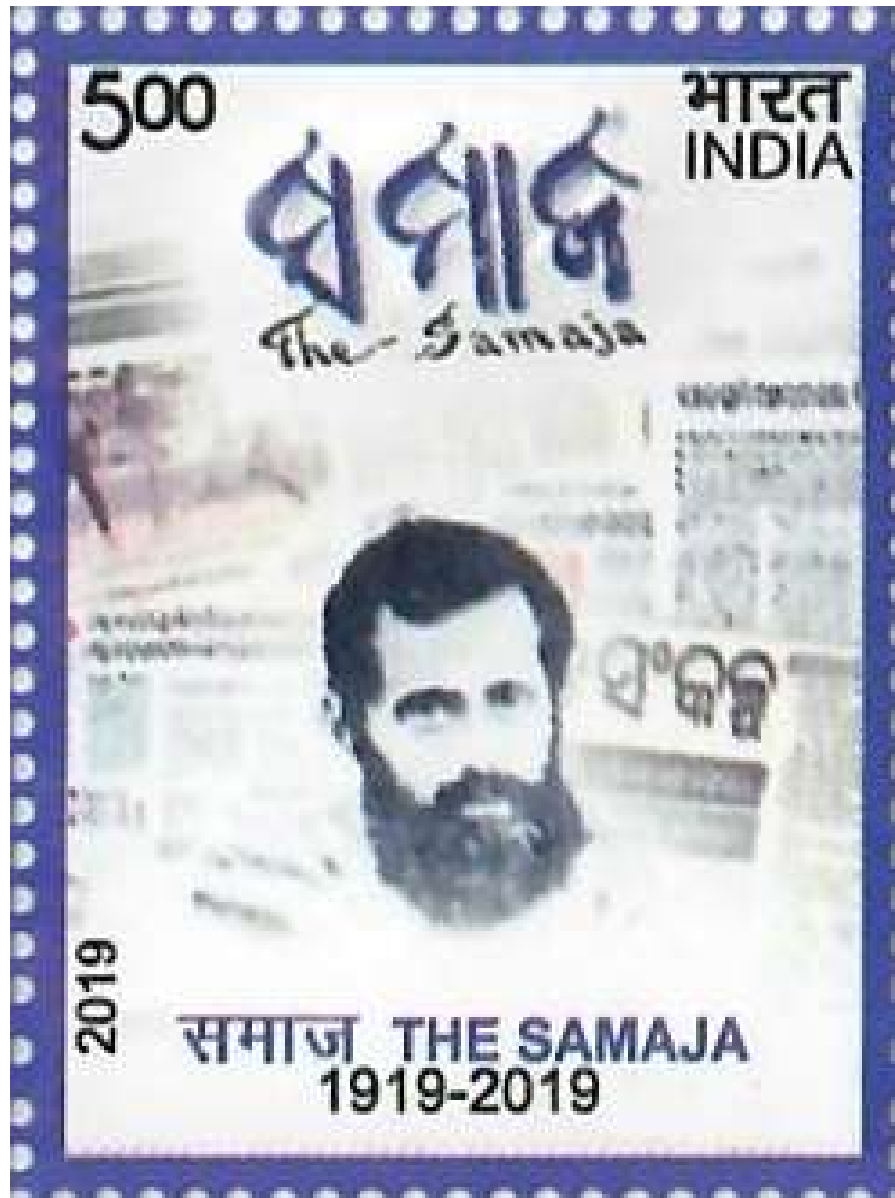


10.

- The world's largest collection of newspapers (different titles) was achieved by Shashanka Dash in 2019 - 4,515 titles.
- The very first newspaper he collected was _____ , one of the oldest papers in India started in 1919. It was started to support the freedom struggle & revive the Odia language, which was under threat at the time.
- Based in Cuttack, it is still run by a public service organisation called Lok Sevak Madal. **Which Odia daily? [5]**
- **Who's the founder**, truly a gem of a person? [5]

safety slide

The Samaja; Utkalamani Gopabandhu Das



11.

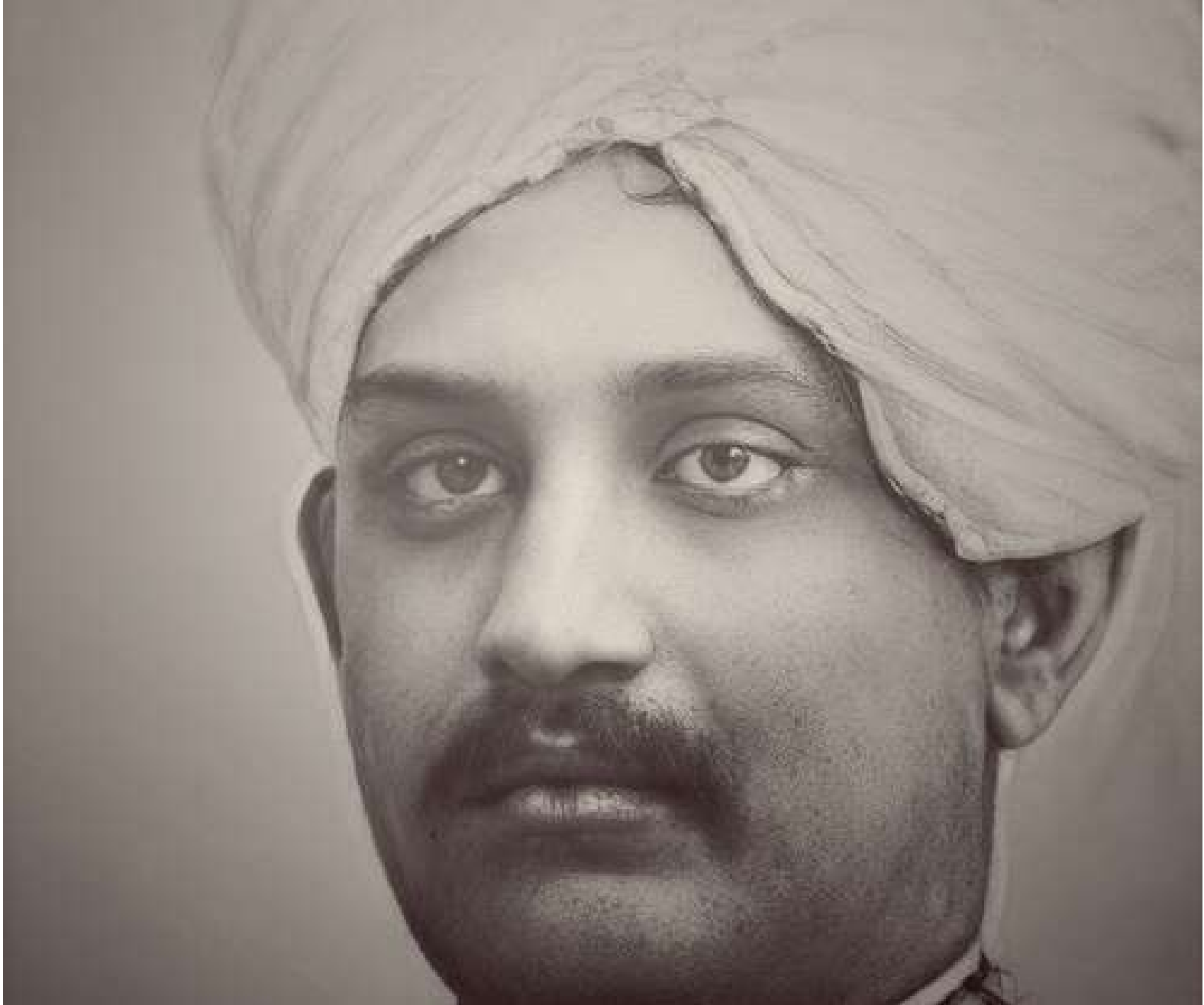
- *SCB Medical College, Cuttack* is Odisha's oldest and largest government medical institution, started as a roadside dispensary to serve pilgrims travelling to Puri during the Maratha rule.
- It was formally established in 1875, with the support of the then English Divisional Commissioner, whose name adorns another university.
- **Who? [5]**
- When it was upgraded to a full medical college in 1944, the post-war British government was unable to fully fund the transition. It was a feudal ruler who stepped in with donations to cover the shortfall.
- The college was renamed in his honour. **Who/ Expand SCB? [5]**

safety slide

T E Ravenshaw



Sriram Chandra Bhanj Deo



12.

- This palace was built in the 18th century by the Bhanja dynasty as their royal residence. It essentially means *"the fortified place of the wood-apple tree"*.
- In 1892, the erstwhile king Sriram Chandra Bhanja Deo made major additions to the front facade - to resemble something built nearly three centuries earlier, located roughly 8,000 kilometres away.
- Today, the palace has been restored as a boutique heritage hotel.
- **ID the palace? [5]**
- **What is it supposed to resemble? [5]**

safety slide

Belgadia Palace

Bel → wood-apple, Gadia → palace



Buckingham Palace



13.

- At the arrivals terminal of the Biju Patnaik International Airport, lies a one-of-a-kind art installation in the world, which changes every fortnight since the past decade.
- Due to its location, this is a more permanent artwork, while the usual work of this artist doesn't last beyond a couple of days
- **Who is the artist**, known otherwise for his ephemeral artworks ? [10]

safety slide

Sudarsan Pattnaik



14.

- It is believed that when the Viceroy Lord Curzon tried entering this famous temple in 1900, he was denied on grounds for being a non-Hindu.
- Unable to enter but unwilling to simply leave, he circumvented this rule by doing something. It is now named after him & is still used to this day by tourists & non-Hindus
- **Which temple, one among the holy trifecta? [3]**
- **What did he do? [7]**

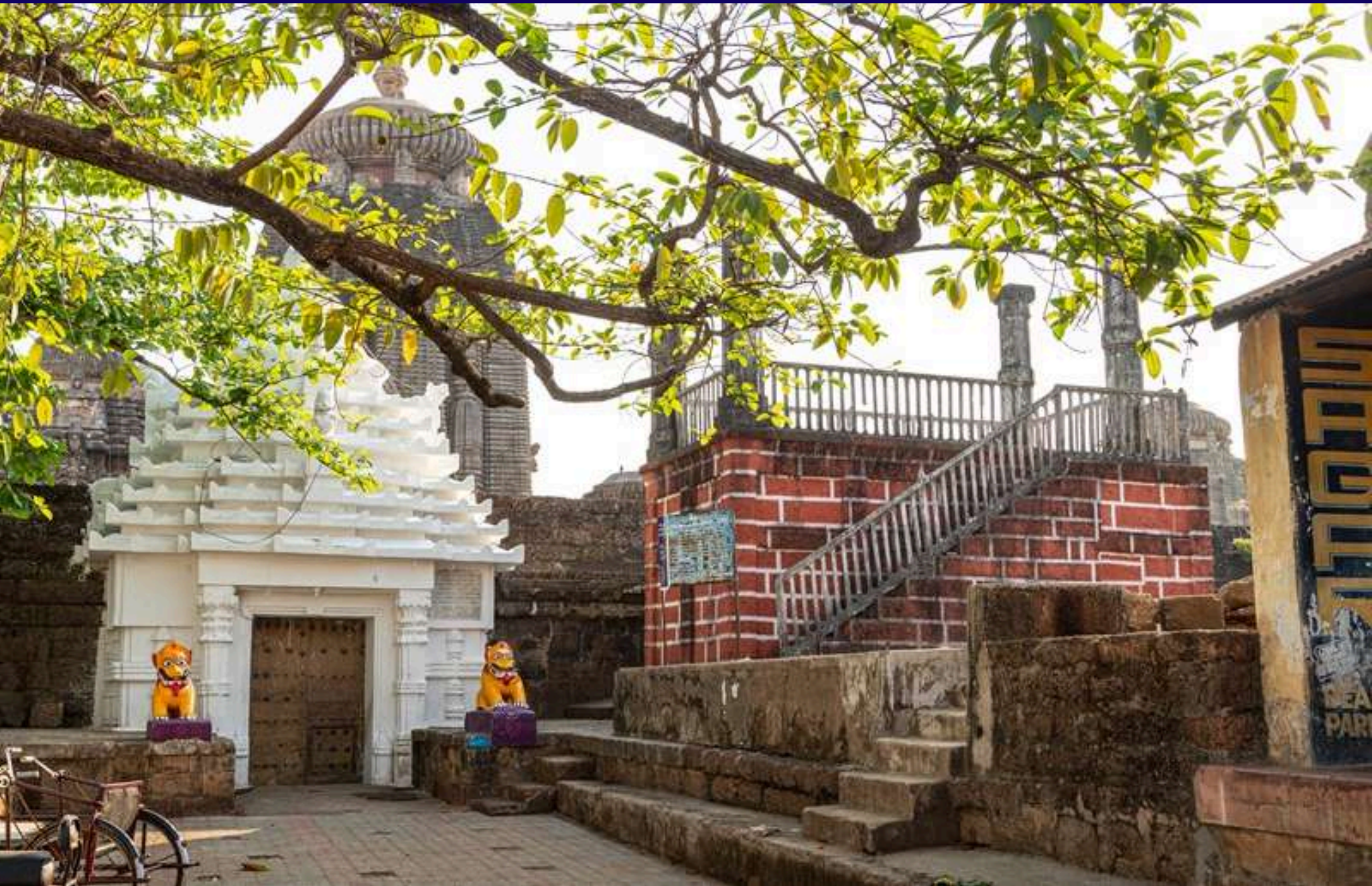
safety slide

Lingaraj Temple



Curzon instructed his men to construct a viewing platform

It is named as Curzon Mandap

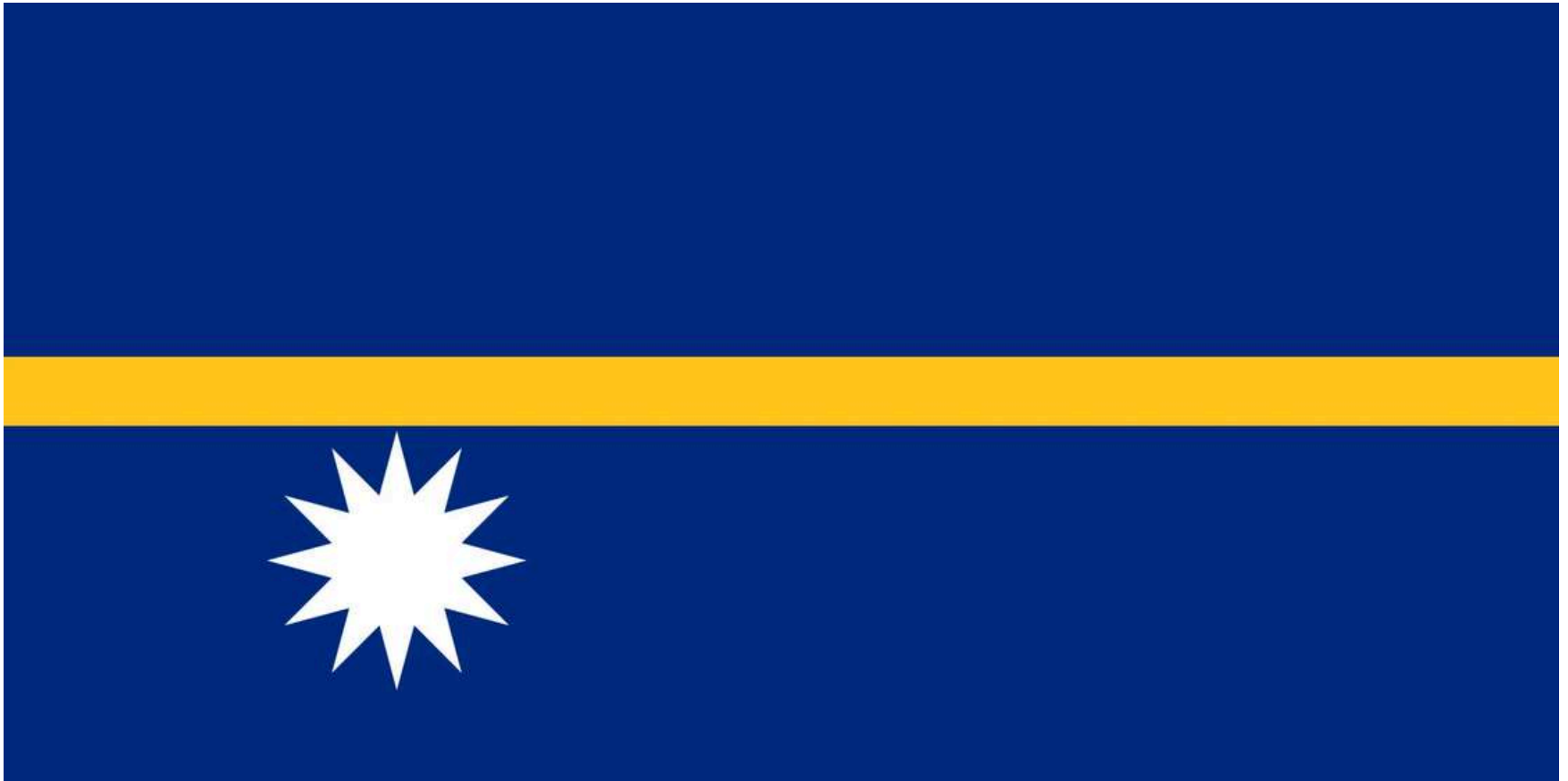


15.

- The world's smallest island nation, whose entire national wealth rested on a single mineral deposited by seabirds, found an unlikely industrial partner in Odisha in 1981.
- The partnership was commercially logical. The island nation sat on some of the world's richest deposits of a mineral critical to fertiliser production, and India needed it to feed its agricultural sector. The result was an alliterative joint venture - a port town combined with its primary product
- The Pacific nation sold its stake in 1993, but the plant it helped build one of Odisha's most significant industrial facilities, processing over a million metric tonnes of fertiliser annually.
- **Name the Pacific island nation [5] and the Indian company it co-founded [5]**

safety slide

Nauru



Paradeep Phosphates



16.

- These Odia traditional circular playing cards were influenced by Persian card game Ganjifeh. The game is popular in Puri and Ganjam districts.
- The name is derived from set of cards, it has nothing to do with a bald father or Ganjam.
- The making process is similar to Pattachitra (next slide). Very often, instead of writing numbers of the cards, painters paint something which fulfils the numeric scale while also validating its mythological theme to Odisha.
- **What are these circular cards called? [5]**
- **What are painted on these cards? [5]**



safety slide

Ganjapa; Dashavatara



17.

- This brand was founded in Manicktala, North Kolkata, by a skilled halwai named _____ Chaurasia who had migrated from Varanasi in 1885. They became globally famous for classics like *nolen gurer jolbhara sandesh*, *misti doi* etc. and became synonymous with quality sweets.
- Because of this reason, many Odia shops adopted this name locally, especially in Cuttack and Bhubaneswar. Today, the name has become a generic term.
- For many Odias, _____ is simply shorthand for a trusted sweet shop, usually with no garlic or onion.
- **What word? [10]**

safety slide

Ganguram



18.

- The logo of this university features a lamp, an open book and a motor, all divided by a river and its tributary- signifying its location.
- It also housed the state's first legislative assembly until it was shifted to Bhubaneswar.
- **ID the university [5]**
- **ID the river & its tributary [3 + 2]**

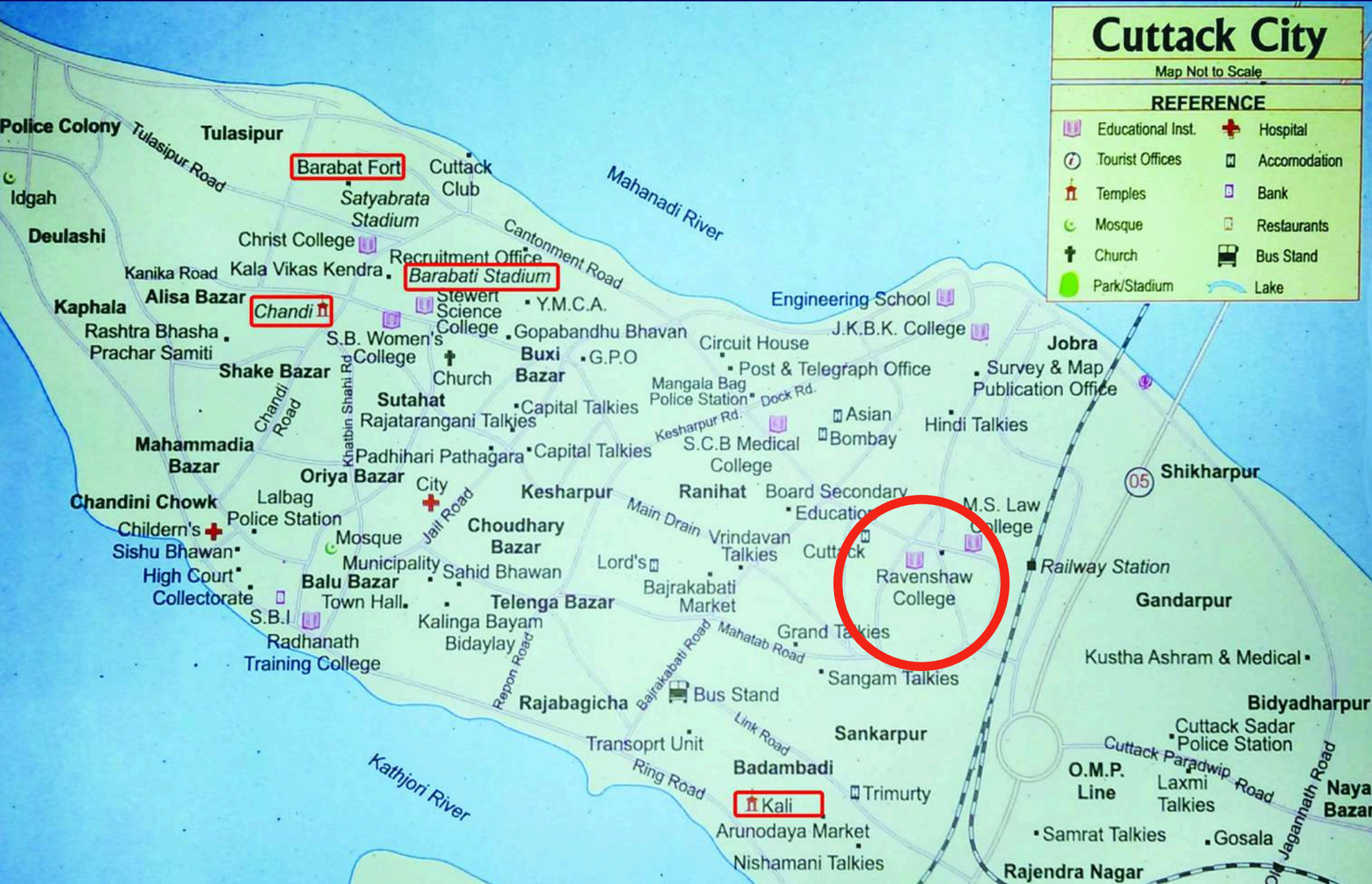


safety slide

Ravenshaw University



Mahanadi & Kathajodi



19.

- _____ was declared a Ramsar site in 2021, Odisha's third after Chilika & Bhitarkanika.
- This lake hosts 104+ species of migratory birds, with over 280,000 birds recorded in a single season. It stretches about 55 km long, covering 743 km² of water surface - making it Asia's largest lake, in a certain category.
- Birds use the reservoir as a wintering ground, feeding on fish and aquatic plants. There are submerged structures in the lake create shallow zones and perches when exposed, which birds sometimes use for resting.
- **Name this lake, which we know for an entirely different reason? [5]**
- **What are these submerged structures? [5]**

safety slide

Hirakud Reservoir

HIRAKUD DAM

— INDIA'S LARGEST DAM —



Submerged temples in Hirakud

When water level lowers during summer they can be seen



20.

- Odisha has developed a tradition of dedicating special days to iconic food items, celebrating them almost like cultural festivals.
- 11 April is celebrated as _____ *Dibasa*. It all began in Nayagarh, Odisha. In 1940s, a local named Bidyadhar Sahoo accidentally left some leftover chenna mixed with sugar and nuts in a wooden oven overnight. **What was thus created? [2]**
- While 20 March is celebrated globally as *Pakhala Dibasa*, the Odia diaspora in North America and Europe delays the celebration to mid-July, for logical and socio-cultural reasons.
- The logical reason is why Pakhala is eaten in the first place and the socio-cultural reason is to coincide it closer to a 3 km phenomenon that happens closer home.
- **What are the two reasons? [4 + 4]**



safety slide

Chennapodo



March was too cold

Weather is warmer in July and the dish feels seasonally appropriate.



[Home](#) [Beaches](#) [Cuisine](#) [Culture](#) [Districts](#) [Food](#) [Lifestyle](#) [Places](#) [Travel](#) [Temples](#) [Waterfall](#)

What is Pakhala Bhata?

Pakhala Bhata, also known as water-soaked rice, is a fermented dish widely eaten in Odisha and other eastern Indian states like Bengal, Assam, Jharkhand, and Chhattisgarh. The liquid part of Pakhala, called 'Torani' (ଡୋରାନୀ), is highly nutritious and aids digestion. This dish comes in three variations:

- **Saja Pakhala (Fresh Pakhala):** Cooked rice soaked in water and served immediately.
- **Basi Pakhala (Fermented Pakhala):** Left overnight to ferment, enhancing its probiotic benefits.
- **Dahi Pakhala (Curd Pakhala):** Mixed with curd for a creamy and tangy flavor.

Why You'll Love This Recipe

- **Cooling Effect:** Helps prevent heat strokes during summer.
- **Easy to Make:** Requires minimal ingredients and preparation.
- **Nutritious:** Rich in probiotics, aiding digestion.
- **Authentic Odia Flavor:** A taste of Odisha's traditional cuisine.

Ratha Yatra



21.

- Located inside Kalinga Stadium, Bhubaneswar, this High Performance Centre was built through a three-way collaboration between the Odisha government, Dalmia Bharat Group, and a federation led by a legendary Indian coach.
- Its structure is an aerodynamic outer shell engineered to withstand cyclonic wind pressures while naturally cooling the interior to save energy.
- However, the structure's true identity reveals itself after dark, when its lights transform it into an unmistakable replica of the sport's equipment (which is also its namesake)
- **What does it resemble? [5]**
- **ID the coach? [5]**







safety slide

Shuttle; Pullela Gopichand



22.

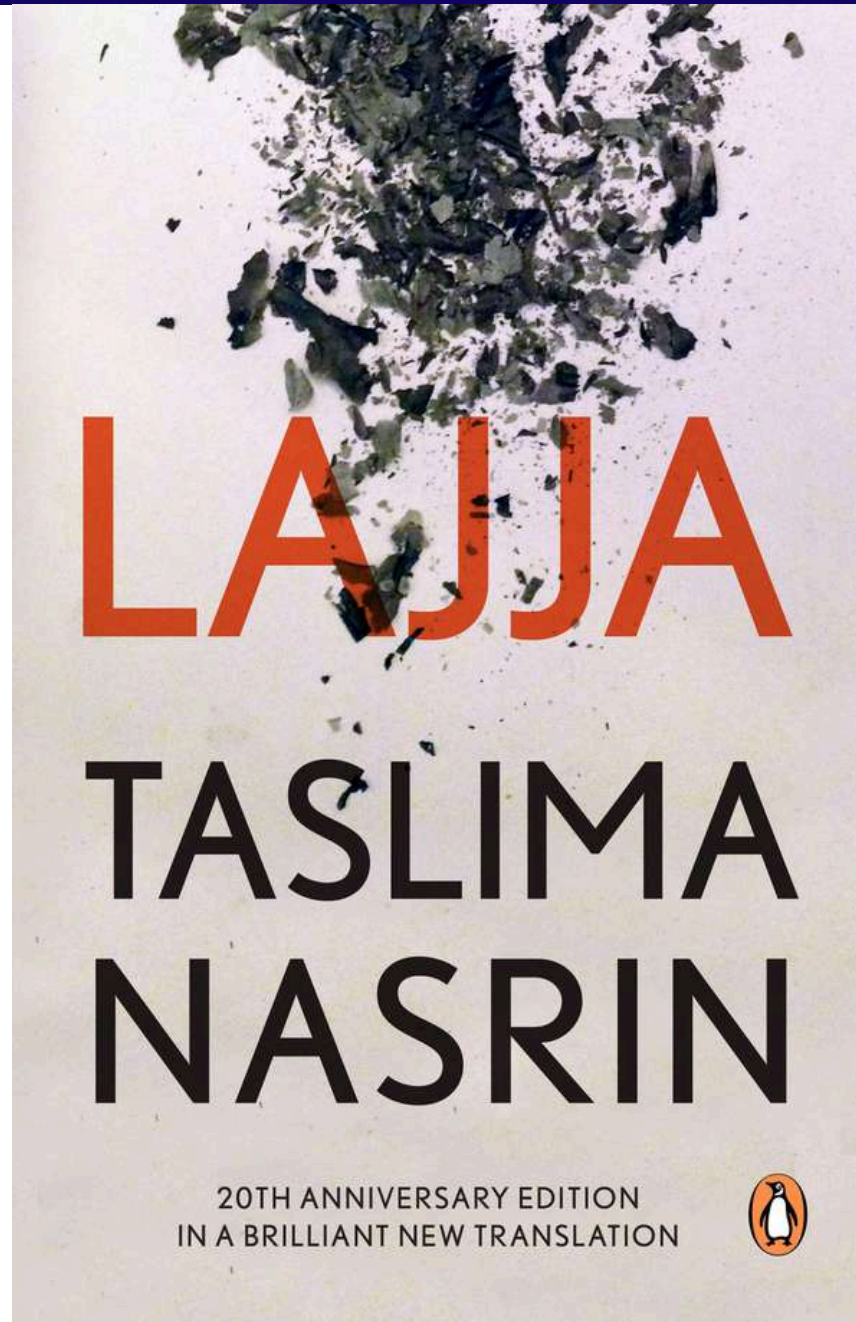
- The first woman Chief Minister of Odisha, Nandini Satpathy was a fierce advocate for women's rights and girl child welfare throughout her political career.
- Her birthday is celebrated as Nandini Diwas National _____' (8) Day on 9 June.
- **FITB [5]**
- She was also a celebrated novelist in Odia literature. She received the Sahitya Bharati Samman Award in 1998 for the Odia translation of a highly controversial book. The book was banned in Bangladesh for the original author's critical scrutiny of Islam and their demands for women's equality.
- **Which banned book / who was the author? [5]**

safety slide

Daughters



Lajja by Taslima Nasrin



23.

- *Orissa Gita* was an alternative proposed but it was less tied to specific political events. It written by the same person, whose other composition was finalised?
- **What work & poet? [5 + 5]**

safety slide

Bande Utkala Janani; Katakabi Laxmikanta Mohapatra



24.

- Chauka is an Odissi stance where the weight of the body is distributed equally on both the sides. The knees are out-turned and the thighs are bent.
- The posture forces the dancer's body to replicate **which geometric silhouette?** [10]





safety slide

Handless torso of Lord Jagannath



25.

- Gotro is a 2019 Bengali family drama film that features a re-rendition of a certain song in Bengali.
- This remake led to a viral social media challenge in West Bengal — daring participants to recreate the song's signature dance steps and nominating friends to do the same.
- The film's producer noted that Bengalis always talk about two Odia things: rasagola and _____.
- Bilung is a village in Northern Odisha that was renamed as _____ Bilung in 2017, due to Mitrabhanu Gauntia, a former schoolteacher.
- **Which song? [10]**

safety slide

Rangabati



INSTRUMENTAL
Odia Super Hit Song
Rangabati O Rangabati

26.

- Rooted in Odisha's history of migration, the Odia diaspora abroad keep their culture alive through festivals while contributing to fields from industry to IT and healthcare.
- One such community is Odias in ____ . Many Odias here have worked with the petroleum, port and infrastructure industries.
- Their logo is cheeky nod to Lord Jagannath while specifying the country they reside in. **Which country? [10]**



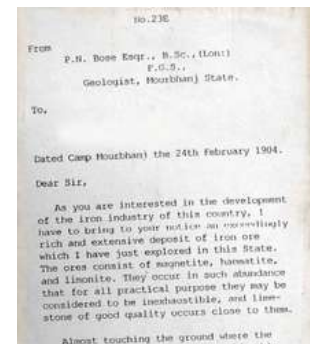
safety slide

Oman



27.

- Geologist P.N. Bose retired early from the Geological Survey of India and took up employment under the Maharaja of Mayurbhanj. It was during his surveys in 1903 along the slopes of the Gorumahisani hills that he made a massive discovery of incredibly high-grade iron ore. Realizing the national industrial implications, Bose sent a historic letter.
- The recipient was a visionary, had spent decades exploring unsuitable sites in MP and Maharashtra. He was on the verge of abandoning his dream of building a domestic steel plant due to a lack of raw materials. Bose's letter single-handedly solved the resource crisis, prompting the industrialist to shift their entire operation to the tribal village of Sakchi.
- **Name this visionary [5]**
- **Identify the township that eventually grew out of the village of Sakchi [5]**



No.23E

From

P.N. Bose Esqr., B.Sc., (Lon:)
F.G.S.,
Geologist, Mourbhanj State.

To,

Dated Camp Mourbhanj the 24th February 1904.

Dear Sir,

As you are interested in the development of the iron industry of this country, I have to bring to your notice an exceedingly rich and extensive deposit of iron ore which I have just explored in this State. The ores consist of magnetite, haematite, and limonite. They occur in such abundance that for all practical purpose they may be considered to be inexhaustible, and limestone of good quality occurs close to them.

Almost touching the ground where the
considerable



safety slide

Jamshedji Tata (JN Tata)



Jamshedpur



28.

- In 2023, the Odisha Transport & Commerce Department hired a contractor to transport a historic thing from one state capital to another.
- Weighing over 8 tonnes, it had been abandoned for more than 7 decades and fallen into disrepair. It was carefully dismantled and then transported ~450km along NH16 in three open trucks.
- Upon arrival, it was reassembled and installed on a 1.1-acre site specifically designated for it, located at a place named after a person closely associated with its use.
- **What is this thing? [10]**

safety slide

Biju Patnaik's Dakota aircraft. The OG Maverick.

He used this to rescue the Indonesian PM and VP in 1947, and the defence of Srinagar in 1948



artofharsha is an IG page run by contemporary Odia illustrator Harsha, who posts digital artworks blending modern art with an Odia spin.

The next 5 questions are related to his digital creations.

29.

- This artwork reimagines one of Western art history's most recognizable images — a Renaissance fresco depicting the moment of divine creation — by replacing its figures entirely with those from an Odia festival, when a sacred drink made from raw mango, water, and spices is offered to the Sun God before being consumed.
- The reaching hands remain, but the life force being transferred is contained in a glass. The traditional drink gives the festival its most popular colloquial name
- **Name the Renaissance art being referenced? [5]**
- **Which Odia festival is reimagined? [5]**



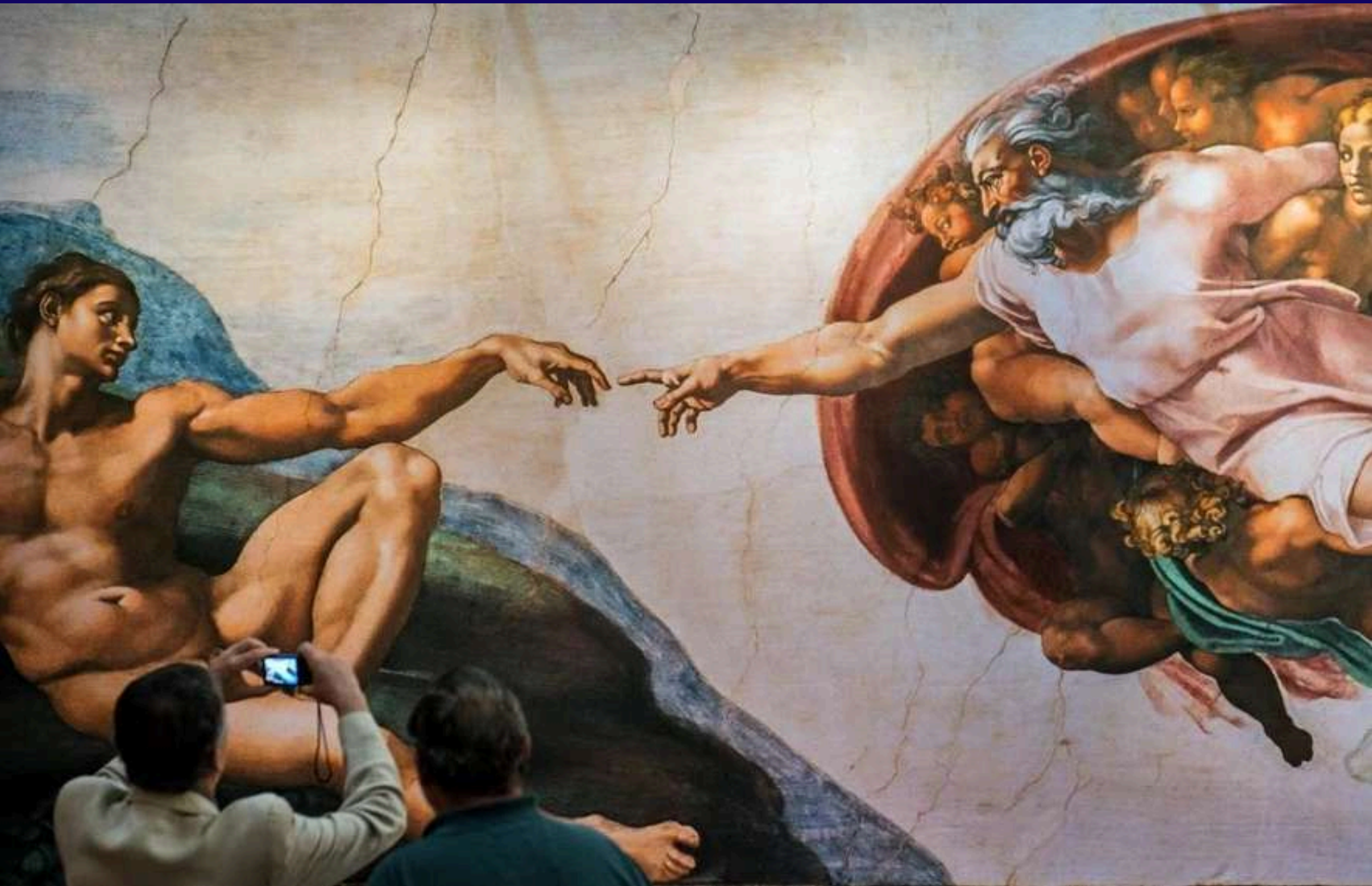


safety slide

Pana Sankranti / Odia New Year



Creation of Adam



30.

- This artwork pays tribute to the very object by turning its contents into its subject by reconstructing the dancer on the lid entirely through the instruments within, replacing every curve and form with triangles, lines, and angles, the only shapes the box ever knew.
- What object is it paying tribute to, which dominated the childhoods of millions of Indian school students? [10]



safety slide

Geometry Box



31.

- When Brahma and Vishnu disputed who among them was supreme, Shiva resolved the argument by transforming into an endless column of *light* with no origin and no end.
- Brahma (Hamsa) flew upward to find the summit. Vishnu (Varaha) burrowed downward to find the base. Neither succeeded. Vishnu returned and admitted defeat honestly — and was blessed for his humility. Brahma, unable to find the top, encountered the Ketaki flower drifting downward and convinced it to falsely testify that he had reached the summit. He was cursed.
- That revelation gave rise to one of Hinduism's most sacred forms, and its first appearance is commemorated each year as a major festival.
- **What is this form called, and which festival marks its origin? [5 + 5]**



safety slide

Jyotirlingam



Somnath



Mallikarjuna



Mahakaleshwar



Omkareshwar



Baidyanath



Bhimashankar



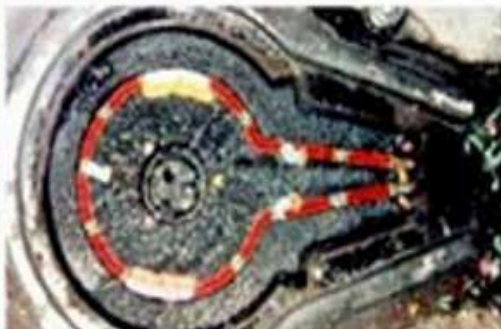
Rameshwaram



Nageshwar



Kashi Vishwanath



Trimbakeshwar



Kedarnath



Ghrishneshwar

Mahashivaratri



32.

- This artwork is a tribute to a legendary Indian singer who has sung many Odia songs, among others. Her last song was a collaboration with Britain's most celebrated animated music acts. In that song, "In the Shadow Light," she sings of a boatman to carry her across deep waters to the other side. In retrospect, it feels less like a lyric and more like a leave-taking.
- **A tribute to whom? Who are her co-passengers? [4 +4]**
- **What is the inspiration of the sky, overlooking the ghats of Varanasi? [2]**





safety slide

Asha Bhonsle



Gorillaz



Starry Night by Van Gogh



33.

- **Which festival is the inspiration? [10]**
- It's the only Indian festival that celebrates menstruation. The belief is that Goddess Bhudevi undergoes her menstrual cycle ahead of the monsoon rains.



safety slide

Raja



fin.